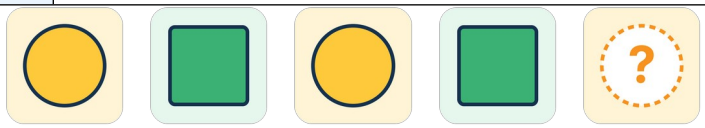
02 · Lesson spec

See the Pattern · 40 minutes · whole class, then groups of 4–6 · fully unplugged · build week

Goal	**I can make and build a shape pattern.**
Core parts	Code + Build
Key words	circle · square · triangle · shape · build · track
Materials	Shape cards (circle, square, triangle); big blocks and boxes (round things and box things); paper shapes cut by an adult; cardboard Ayo; build card (Printables); a phone to photo each track



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Show** a road of shape cards: circle, square, circle, square. **Ask:** “What comes next on Ayo’s road?” (circle)
- Hold up cardboard Ayo: “Ayo is made of shapes too: a box and a round ball!” Point and name: square, circle.
- **Hand signs:** circle = draw a circle · square = draw four sides · triangle = make a roof with your hands · build = stack fists · track = slide a hand forward.

2. Do in groups (25 min)

a) Pattern hop, whole class (5 min) · Move

- Children hop along a flat floor track of shape cards, saying each shape aloud: “circle, square, circle, square…”

b) Lay and continue a shape strip (7 min) · Core: Code

- Groups lay circle–square–circle–square with shape cards; a friend continues it with 2 more.

c) Build Ayo’s pattern road (13 min) · Core: Build

- Groups line up big blocks, boxes and card shapes in an AB pattern (round, box, round, box…) to make a road.
- **Another group checks it** and adds the next 2 pieces. Then walk cardboard Ayo along the road.
- Photo each finished road (assessment evidence). If time: make a shape-pattern belt for Ayo (optional).
- **Stretch:** two features in one track (red circle, blue square, red circle, blue square).

3. Share (10 min)

- **Activity Book page** (4 min): draw the next shape; match each Ayo part to its shape. Not marked.
- **Create:** make a shape pattern with paper circles, squares and triangles.
- **Close:** “We saw a pattern, then we built it. That is what designers do!”

Common mistakes

- Building with any blocks in any order → say the pattern aloud as each piece goes down.
- Confusing square and triangle → count the sides together with a finger.

What if it doesn’t work?

- Not enough blocks → use paper shapes on the floor as the road.

- Too noisy to build → build on tables with small paper shapes (still big enough to be safe).

Support and stretch

- **Support:** copy the teacher's first 4 pieces, then add 1.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): colour and shape together.

How we check

Observation + photo. Tick each child who **builds and continues a colour or shape pattern track**.

> **Safety**
> Adults do any cutting. Big pieces only. Tracks stay flat; no stacking above knee height. Hop on the spot or along a flat track, never over boxes.